

Chris Allen

General Manager, Wailana Grand Resort
Biography - Hawaii Hotel and Lodging Association Speaker Profile

Chris Allen is the General Manager of the Wailana Grand Resort in Waikiki, a position he has held since February 2019. In that role he oversees a 340-room full-service property with an annual operating budget exceeding \$28 million, a team of 210 employees, and a portfolio of dining, spa, and event venues.

Prior to joining the Wailana Grand, Chris served as Director of Rooms at the Mauna Kea Beach Hotel on the Big Island and as Front Office Manager at the Grand Hyatt Kauai Resort and Spa. He holds a Bachelor of Science in Hospitality Management from the University of Hawaii at Manoa and completed the Cornell University School of Hotel Administration Executive Development Program in 2017.

Under his leadership the Wailana Grand has achieved successive years of RevPAR index gains against the Waikiki competitive set, was named a Conde Nast Traveler Readers Choice property in 2024, and received the Hawaii Tourism Authority Malama Hawaii recognition award in 2023.

Outside of his professional role, Chris Allen is an active competitive paddler with the Koa Kai Outrigger Canoe Club, where he competes in the Masters Men OC6 division. He has participated in seven consecutive Kaiwi Channel Relay crossings.

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